

GOLDEN PALM HOTEL

Website Project Proposal

Prepared By: Camagu Godana
Organisation: Golden Palm Hotel
Version: 1.0
Date: May 2026
Status: Draft for Review

Where Every Stay Becomes a Memory

1. Organisation Overview

Organisation	Golden Palm Hotel
Industry	Hospitality & Tourism
Location	Durban, KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa
Category	4-Star Boutique Hotel
Website Status	New Development Required

1.1 Brief History

Golden Palm Hotel was established in 2008 in Durban, KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa. Founded by the Naidoo family with a vision to bring warm African hospitality and modern luxury together, the hotel began as a 24-room boutique property on the Durban beachfront. Over the years, it expanded to 72 elegantly appointed rooms and suites, gaining a reputation as one of the city's premier coastal destinations.

By 2015, Golden Palm Hotel had earned multiple regional hospitality awards, including Best Boutique Hotel in KwaZulu-Natal. The hotel has undergone two major refurbishments — in 2013 and 2020 — to modernise its facilities while preserving its distinctly warm, African-influenced design aesthetic. It is a proud member of the South African Tourism and Hospitality Association (SATHA).

1.2 Mission Statement

"To deliver an unparalleled guest experience through personalised service, luxurious comfort, and authentic African hospitality that creates lasting memories for every visitor."

1.3 Vision Statement

"To be the most celebrated boutique hotel destination on the South African coastline, recognised globally for our commitment to excellence, sustainability, and cultural authenticity."

1.4 Target Audience

- Domestic and international leisure travellers seeking premium coastal accommodation
- Business travellers and corporate event organisers
- Couples planning romantic getaways, honeymoons, and anniversary celebrations
- Families seeking a quality beachside holiday experience
- Conference and wedding planners seeking a unique venue
- Travel agents and tour operators in the Southern African tourism market

2. Website Goals and Objectives

2.1 Primary Goals

- Increase direct online bookings, reducing reliance on third-party booking platforms (e.g., Booking.com, Expedia) and commission fees
- Establish a strong digital brand presence that reflects the hotel's luxury positioning
- Provide prospective guests with comprehensive, visually compelling information about rooms, amenities, and facilities
- Generate qualified leads for conference, wedding, and corporate event enquiries
- Improve search engine visibility for target keywords in the KZN hospitality market

2.2 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The following KPIs will be used to measure the success of the new website:

KPI Metric	Baseline Target (Month 3)	Growth Target (Month 12)
Monthly Website Visitors	1,500 unique visitors	5,000 unique visitors
Direct Online Bookings	20 bookings/month	80 bookings/month
Bounce Rate	Below 55%	Below 40%
Average Session Duration	1 min 30 sec	3 min+
Enquiry Form Submissions	10/month	40/month
Search Engine Ranking	Top 10 for key terms	Top 3 for key terms
Mobile Traffic Share	50% of total traffic	60% of total traffic

3. Current Website Analysis

Golden Palm Hotel currently operates a basic informational website created in 2019. The following analysis has been conducted to inform the redesign process.

3.1 Strengths of the Existing Website

- Contains basic contact information and physical address
- Includes a photo gallery with some high-quality room imagery
- Lists room types and general pricing tiers
- Has a functioning contact form for enquiries

3.2 Weaknesses and Areas for Improvement

- No integrated online booking engine — all reservations directed to third-party platforms
- Poor mobile responsiveness; the site is not optimised for smartphones or tablets
- Outdated visual design that does not reflect the hotel's current luxury branding
- Slow page load times due to uncompressed images and legacy code
- No search engine optimisation (SEO) strategy in place
- Absence of a blog or content marketing section to drive organic traffic
- No live chat or WhatsApp integration for customer support
- Missing social media feeds and review integration (e.g., TripAdvisor, Google Reviews)
- No event/conference enquiry section with detailed venue specifications

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

4.1 Core Pages

- Homepage — Hero banner, key value propositions, featured rooms, testimonials, and CTAs
- About Us — Hotel history, team profiles, awards, and certifications
- Rooms & Suites — Individual room pages with photo galleries, amenities, and pricing
- Dining — Restaurant menus, hours, atmosphere gallery, and reservation links
- Facilities & Amenities — Spa, pool, gym, and beachfront descriptions with imagery
- Events & Conferences — Venue floor plans, capacity tables, and enquiry form
- Weddings — Package details, photo gallery, and booking enquiry form
- Gallery — High-resolution, categorised image and video gallery
- Special Offers — Dynamic promotions and seasonal packages
- Blog / News — Travel tips, local attractions, and hotel news for SEO
- Contact Us — Map integration, contact form, WhatsApp button, and live chat

4.2 Key Functionality

- Online Booking Engine — Real-time room availability calendar with secure payment gateway (PayFast / PayGate)
- Mobile-First Responsive Design — Fully optimised across all device types
- SEO Optimisation — Structured data, meta tags, sitemap, and Google Analytics integration
- Social Media Integration — Instagram feed, Facebook page linking, sharing buttons
- Review Aggregator — TripAdvisor and Google Reviews widget
- WhatsApp Chat Button — Direct messaging for instant guest support
- Newsletter Subscription — Email capture with Mailchimp integration
- Multi-Currency Display — ZAR as primary, with USD/GBP/EUR conversion indicators

5. Design and User Experience

5.1 Design Aesthetic and Branding

The website design will reflect the Golden Palm Hotel's identity: warm African luxury with a modern, sophisticated coastal sensibility. The visual language will communicate prestige and relaxation, appealing to discerning travellers.

Design Style	Modern Luxury with African Coastal Influences
Inspiration	Warm sand tones, tropical palm motifs, Indian Ocean blues
Aesthetic	Clean, editorial layout reminiscent of high-end hotel brands

5.2 Colour Scheme

Palm Gold (#B8860B)	Ivory White (#FFFDF5)	Ocean Deep (#1A3A4A)	Sand Beige (#D4B483)
Primary Accent	Background	Headings & Text	Supporting Accent

5.3 Typography

Primary Heading Font	Playfair Display — Elegant serif for hotel name, page titles, and hero text
Secondary Heading Font	Montserrat (SemiBold) — Clean sans-serif for section headings
Body Copy Font	Open Sans (Regular/Light) — Highly readable for descriptions and content
Accent / CTA Font	Montserrat (Bold, uppercase tracking) — Used for buttons and labels
Font Hierarchy	H1: 48–64px H2: 32–36px H3: 24–26px Body: 16px Captions: 13px

5.4 Layout and Design Approach

- Full-screen hero video or high-quality photograph on the homepage with an overlay booking widget
- Grid-based room display with hover effects revealing key room details and a direct 'Book Now' CTA
- Sticky navigation bar that transitions from transparent to solid-gold on scroll
- Generous whitespace to create a premium, uncluttered feel
- Asymmetric editorial layouts in the About and Dining sections for visual interest
- Full-bleed image sections alternating with text panels for visual rhythm

5.5 User Experience Considerations

- Navigation — Maximum three-click depth to any page; primary navigation with clear dropdown menus
- Accessibility — WCAG 2.1 AA compliant; adequate colour contrast, alt text for all images, keyboard navigation
- Booking Flow — Streamlined 3-step booking process: Select Dates → Choose Room → Confirm & Pay
- Page Load Speed — Target under 2.5 seconds; lazy image loading, CDN implementation
- Trust Signals — Prominently displayed star ratings, security badges, and guest testimonials

5.6 Low-Fidelity Wireframes — Key Screens

The following wireframe descriptions outline the information hierarchy for the website's primary pages:

Page	Layout Description
Homepage	Top: Sticky navbar Hero: Full-screen image with booking widget overlay Below: USP strip (3 icons) Featured Rooms grid Testimonials carousel Instagram feed strip Footer
Rooms & Suites	Top: Navbar Breadcrumb Filter bar (room type, guests, view) Room card grid (image, name, price, CTA) Sidebar: Quick booking widget Footer
Room Detail	Top: Full-width room image gallery (6 images) Room title & highlights Amenities list Pricing block with 'Book Now' CTA Similar Rooms strip Footer
Contact Page	Top: Navbar Contact info cards (3 columns: Phone, Email, Address) Embedded Google Map Contact form WhatsApp CTA button Footer

6. Technical Requirements

6.1 Hosting and Domain

Domain Name	www.goldenpalmdurban.co.za (or .com)
Domain Registrar	Domains.co.za or Afrihost (South African registrar recommended)
Hosting Type	Cloud VPS Hosting — recommended for performance and scalability
Hosting Provider	Afrihost or Hetzner South Africa (local CDN for low latency)

SSL Certificate	Let's Encrypt (Free) or Comodo Positive SSL — mandatory for booking engine
Email Hosting	Professional email (e.g., reservations@goldenpalmdurban.co.za) via Zoho Mail or G Suite
CDN	Cloudflare — for performance, security, and South African edge servers
Backup	Daily automated backups with 30-day retention

6.2 Technology Stack

Frontend	HTML5, CSS3 (with CSS Variables & Grid/Flexbox), JavaScript (ES6+)
CSS Framework	Tailwind CSS — for rapid, consistent utility-based styling
Frontend Framework	React.js (Next.js) — for server-side rendering and SEO benefits
Backend / CMS	WordPress with Elementor Pro — for ease of content management
Booking Engine	HiRUM or SiteMinder PMS integration, or custom API
Payment Gateway	PayFast (South Africa) with card and EFT payment support
Database	MySQL (via WordPress) with Redis caching
Version Control	Git (GitHub) — for codebase management and collaboration
Analytics	Google Analytics 4 + Google Search Console + Hotjar (heatmaps)
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA compliance tools: axe DevTools and Lighthouse audits

7. Timeline and Milestones

The following project timeline outlines a realistic 16-week development schedule from project initiation to live deployment:

Phase	Milestone	Duration / Date
Phase 1	Project Kick-off: Brief finalisation, stakeholder sign-off, NDA & contracts	Week 1
Phase 1	Discovery & Research: Competitor analysis, user research, content audit	Week 2
Phase 2	Information Architecture: Sitemap, user flows, and content strategy	Week 3

Phase 2	Wireframes: Low-fidelity wireframes for all key pages (client review)	Week 4
Phase 3	Brand & Style Guide: Colour palette, typography, UI component library	Week 5
Phase 3	High-Fidelity Mockups: Visual designs for Homepage, Rooms, Contact pages	Week 6–7
Phase 3	Client Design Review & Approval — Revision round included	Week 8
Phase 4	Frontend Development: HTML/CSS/JS, responsive implementation	Week 9–10
Phase 4	CMS Integration: WordPress setup, content entry, booking engine	Week 11–12
Phase 5	Backend & Integrations: Payment gateway, email, analytics setup	Week 13
Phase 5	Quality Assurance: Cross-browser, cross-device, accessibility, speed tests	Week 14
Phase 5	User Acceptance Testing (UAT): Client walkthrough and feedback	Week 15
Phase 6	Launch Preparation: DNS migration, SSL, staging to live deployment	Week 16
Phase 6	Post-Launch Support: Bug fixes, performance monitoring, handover training	Weeks 17–18

8. Budget Estimate

The following budget estimate is based on current South African market rates for professional web development, hosting, and ongoing maintenance. All amounts are in South African Rand (ZAR) and inclusive of VAT.

Category	Description	Estimated Cost (ZAR)
Discovery	Project research, competitor analysis, content audit, information architecture	R 8,500.00
Design	UI/UX design, wireframes, high-fidelity mockups, style guide, 2 revision rounds	R 22,000.00
Development	Frontend & backend development, CMS setup, booking engine integration	R 55,000.00

Integrations	Payment gateway (PayFast), Google Analytics, CRM, WhatsApp, social feeds	R 9,500.00
Content	Professional photography (1-day shoot), copywriting (all pages), image optimisation	R 18,000.00
SEO Setup	On-page SEO, keyword strategy, Google Business Profile, sitemap submission	R 6,500.00
Testing	QA testing, accessibility audit, cross-browser/device testing, performance audit	R 5,000.00
Hosting	VPS hosting (1 year) — Hetzner South Africa, SSL certificate, CDN (Cloudflare)	R 4,800.00
Domain	Domain registration (.co.za) for 2 years, email hosting setup	R 1,200.00
Training	CMS training for hotel staff (2 sessions), user manual documentation	R 3,500.00
Maintenance	6-month post-launch support, security updates, performance monitoring	R 9,600.00
TOTAL ESTIMATED BUDGET		R 143 600,00

Budget Notes:

- Ongoing monthly maintenance after the initial 6-month period is estimated at R 1,600/month
- Photography budget may increase if drone/aerial footage is required (additional R 4,500)
- Paid advertising (Google Ads, Meta Ads) is not included and is recommended as a separate marketing budget
- All quoted amounts are estimates; final pricing subject to formal scope agreement

9. References

The following references informed the research and recommendations in this proposal:

- Afrihost. (2025). VPS Hosting Plans and Pricing. Retrieved from <https://www.afrihost.com/hosting/vps>
- Google. (2026). Core Web Vitals report. Google Search Central. Retrieved from <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/core-web-vitals>
- Hetzner South Africa. (2025). Web Hosting and Domain Services. Retrieved from <https://www.hetzner.co.za>
- Nielsen Norman Group. (2024). Usability guidelines for hotel and hospitality websites. NN/g Research Reports. Retrieved from <https://www.nngroup.com>
- PayFast. (2025). Integration documentation and payment gateway features. Retrieved from <https://www.payfast.co.za/developers>
- South African Tourism. (2024). Annual South African Tourism Performance Report. South African Tourism Board. Retrieved from <https://www.southafrica.net>

StatCounter. (2026). Mobile operating system market share: South Africa. Retrieved from <https://gs.statcounter.com>

W3C. (2023). Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1. World Wide Web Consortium. Retrieved from <https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/>

WordPress. (2026). WordPress CMS platform and Elementor Pro documentation. Retrieved from <https://wordpress.org> and <https://elementor.com>

End of Proposal | Golden Palm Hotel Website Project | Version 1.0 | May 2026